

Phase 5 Checklist — Designing SinhalaBridge as a Space

Run every wireframe and layout decision through these four checks before moving to visual styling

1. Wayfinding over reading

Visitors scan for landmarks — header, nav, primary action — before reading anything closely.

- Header (XP/streak) and bottom nav appear in the same position on every screen
- Exactly one dominant action per screen (e.g. “Start Practice”) — no competing CTAs at equal weight
- Learner can tell which screen they're on from layout alone, before reading text
- Bottom nav order and icons never change between screens

2. Agency and control

Never trap the visitor — especially important since gamification mechanics can start to feel coercive.

- Placement/preview available before any signup wall (already locked in Phase 2)
- No autoplay audio — pronunciation audio (FR-LC-04) is tap-to-play only
- Skip/back always available, even mid-exercise, even at XP cost
- No guilt-inducing modals for broken streaks — motivate, don't punish
- Explore mode (FR-RM-03) is easy to find, not buried in a menu

3. Trust is spatial before verbal

Visual polish and consistency are judged before any text is read.

- Card shapes, buttons, and icons are visually identical across every screen
- Mascot/icon set appears in everyday screens, not just completion moments
- A loading state (not blank white) shows during the 3G/5-second load window
- Bilingual layout (Sinhala + English) feels balanced, not like an afterthought

4. Liveness

A site is judged as current unless it visibly proves otherwise.

- XP and streak numbers update the instant an action completes (NFR-02: 300ms)
- Stage/progress cards reflect real state with no lag after an exercise
- Empty/unbuilt stages (2–8 pre-launch) show an intentional “coming soon” state, not a dead link
- No stale dates, placeholder text, or broken assets left visible to real users

Use this checklist when reviewing the Lesson screen wireframe (Phase 7) and again before each new screen moves from wireframe to visual build (Phase 8). It's a design lens, not a formal pipeline deliverable — keep it open as a working reference rather than filing it away.